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INTRODUCTION TO TRIGNOMETRY

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There is perhaps nothing which so occupies the middle position of mathematics as trigonometry.

— J.F. Herbart (1890)

4.1 Introduction

1. Suppose the students of a school are visiting Qutub Minar. Now, if a student is looking at the top of the Minar, a right triangle can be imagined to be made, as shown in **Fig 8.1**. Can the student find out the height of the Minar, without actually measuring it?

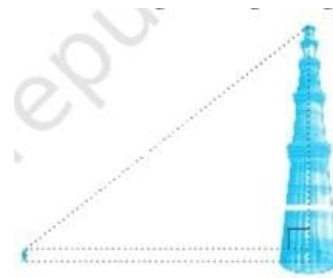


Fig. 8.1

2. Suppose a is sitting on the balcony of her house located on the bank of a river. She is looking down at a flower pot placed on a stair of a temple situated nearby on the other bank of the river. A right triangle is imagined to be made in this situation as shown in **Fig. 8.2**. If you know the height at which the person is sitting, can you find the width of the river?

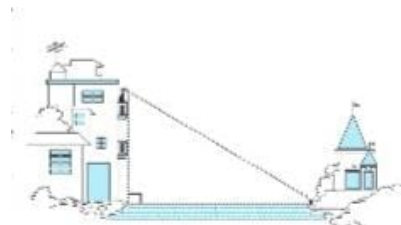


Fig. 8.2